Discovery Notes

Baraka Mini Mart

Client / Business Name: Baraka Mini Mart

Business Owner / Manager: James Murithi

Industry: Retail — General/Convenience Store

Meeting Date: 22/7/2026

Stakeholders Present: James Murithi

Consultant: Luis Muchiri

1. Business Summary

1.1 Business Overview

Baraka Mini Mart is a neighborhood convenience store. The area previously had few small kiosks, and James started the business to close that distance/access gap by offering a one-stop shop for everyday household needs.

1.2 Why the Business Exists

- Limited nearby kiosks meant customers had to travel further for everyday items.
- James opened Baraka Mini Mart to offer convenience and a single, reliable stop for household products.

1.3 Products & Services

The shop stocks everyday household products across the following categories:

- Food & Groceries — Maize flour, Wheat flour, Rice, Sugar, Salt, Cooking oil, Tea leaves, Milk (fresh and long-life), Bread, Eggs
- Beverages — Soft drinks, Bottled water, Fruit juices, Energy drinks
- Household Items — Bar soap, Washing powder, Dishwashing liquid, Tissue paper, Toothpaste, Toothbrushes, Bathing soap
- Snacks — Biscuits, Crisps, Sweets, Chocolate, Chewing gum
- Personal Care — Sanitary pads, Baby diapers, Petroleum jelly, Body lotion
- Other Items — Airtime scratch cards, Matches, Candles

1.4 Target Customers

- Parents
- University students
- Food kiosks
- Small restaurants
- Offices

Most customers are walk-ins; some place orders by phone call or text message.

1.5 Operating Pattern

Busiest hours: 7:00–9:00 AM and 5:00–8:00 PM (rush hours)

Competitive edge: Convenient location

1.6 Business Objective

To be a reliable neighborhood supermarket.

2. Organizational Structure

Baraka Mini Mart currently operates with four roles. There is a single branch and no formal reporting hierarchy beyond the manager.

Role	Key Responsibilities
Manager (James Murithi)	Decides what to buy and which supplier to use; approves purchases; handles supplier payments; reviews daily sales and cash.
Cashier	Serves customers; records sales in a notebook; receives and counts cash and M-Pesa payments; issues handwritten receipts.
Shop Attendant	Arranges products on shelves; informs the manager when stock is low; assists customers in finding products.
Storekeeper	Receives stock from suppliers; manages inventory; supplies shelves; reports damaged or expired items.

2.1 Departmental Notes

Two functional areas were described during discovery. Full process mapping for these will be carried out; the raw notes are captured here for reference.

Procurement

- Storekeeper or shop attendant reports low stock to the manager, or the manager checks shelves and the storeroom directly.
- Manager contacts the supplier by phone call or WhatsApp message.
- Supplier delivers the goods.
- Storekeeper and manager confirm quantities received.
- Manager approves the delivery upon satisfaction.
- Supplier provides the manager an invoice or delivery note.
- Payment is made immediately or on credit, depending on the arrangement.

Finance

- The business has no in-house accountant.
- An external accountant is hired to file taxes.

3. Business Documents

Documents identified or referenced during discovery:

- Supplier invoices
- Supplier delivery notes
- Handwritten sales receipts (issued by the cashier)

4. Pain Points

Recorded as described by the client:

- Stock management — stock levels and product expiration are hard to track.
- Sales and revenue mismatch.
- No visibility into best-selling products.
- Difficulty keeping track of suppliers.
- Credit sales tracking is a burden.
- Manually managing the business is tiring.

4.1 Reports the Client Wants to See

- Daily sales and profit
- Cash collected vs. M-Pesa received
- Best-selling products
- Stock levels
- Products near expiration
- Money owed to suppliers
- Money customers owe (credit sales)
- Which employee handled each sale